

Yijia Li

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EXPERIENCE

Contract Software Engineer — Microsoft, Copilot

05/2024 – 11/2025

- Built and maintained a scalable LLM evaluation data pipeline for Copilot GenAI post-training RLHF iterations, supporting agentic workflows across tool use (Code Interpreter) and RAG / search-retrieval scenarios.
- Developed automated evaluation and regression monitoring infrastructure (e.g., win-rate, correctness, grounding) to validate model changes and detect quality regressions across datasets, prompts, and model versions.
- Implemented data processing and analysis workflows to triage production-like traffic, identify recurring failure patterns in multi-step agent execution (tool invocation, retrieval grounding, response generation)
- Partnered with researchers and product teams to translate model quality issues into actionable engineering improvements, driving measurable gains in core chatbot metrics and improving reliability across successive releases.

AI Trainer — Scale AI, Coding Agent Track

07/2023 – 04/2024

- Developed high-complexity code evaluation data suites for LLM fine-tuning, encompassing edge-cases scenarios and competitive programming standards to enhance model reasoning capabilities.
- Reviewed, classified, and improved AI-generated code for correctness, efficiency, style, and instruction-following.

Software Engineer — BeaconFire, Walmart

05/2023 – 05/2024

- Built and maintained Java/Spring Boot backend services for distributed microservices in high-concurrency environments, improving scalability and reliability.
- Implemented Kafka-based event streaming to enable scalable, fault-tolerant communication across services.
- Designed an API gateway layer for request routing, traffic buffering, and service decoupling.
- Developed RESTful APIs with CRUD access to Cassandra, supporting high-throughput data storage and retrieval.
- Automated containerized deployments with Docker and Kubernetes, integrating CI/CD for repeatable releases.
- Ensured API reliability with comprehensive JUnit/Mockito unit and integration tests, plus endpoint validation using Postman.

Software Engineer — Zhongrong Trust, Core Business Systems

12/2019 – 07/2021

- Developed Spring Boot backend services for enterprise financial web applications, emphasizing transactional consistency and data integrity across core workflows.
- Delivered automation features including notifications, document sharing, and advanced sorting/filtering capabilities.
- Improved PostgreSQL and DynamoDB performance by redesigning index strategies and refining access patterns, reducing average query latency by 40%.
- Implemented Redis caching for frequently accessed PDF documents, cutting read latency and reducing database load.
- Built and operated AWS infrastructure: deployed services on EC2, configured CloudFront for faster content delivery, integrated SES for reliable transactional email, and implemented Lambda jobs to process application logs and store analytics outputs in S3 for monitoring and reporting.

SKILLS

Programming: Java, Python, Swift, JavaScript, TypeScript, CSS, HTML, SQL

Certificate: Microsoft AI & ML Engineering Professional Certificate

Systems & Data Infra: LangGraph, Redis, PostgreSQL, Cassandra, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Spark, Docker, Kubernetes, Kafka, AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, DynamoDB, CloudFront, SES), Spring Boot

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Science — The University of Texas at Austin

08/2023 – 12/2025

Master's Degree — University of Southern California

08/2021 – 05/2023

Bachelor's Degree — Shanghai University of International Business and Economics

09/2010 – 06/2014